

Die Bettelordensstudia im Gefüge des spätmittelalterlichen Universitätswesens. By Isnard Wilhelm Frank. (Institut für Europäische Geschichte Mainz, 83.) Pp. 59. Stuttgart: Steiner Wiesbaden, 1988. 3 515 05244 5

This brief monograph is concerned with the integration of the mendicant *studia* with university faculties of theology in the later medieval period. The author argues that the European prototype for the incorporation of the mendicants into a faculty of theology was provided by Paris. Here, however, the repercussions of this union in the form of intermittent feuding between mendicant and secular masters of theology persisted for the greater part of a hundred years, and, at one stage, it seemed that it would end in the destruction of the university. The mendicants were similarly incorporated at Toulouse and at Prague, but incorporation was not always so complete at other universities. For example, at Bologna in the early fifteenth century the mendicants received the privileges of the Parisian friars, although they were not fully incorporated within the university structure. The author gives a general sketch of the features of mendicant organisation in the medieval universities and is quite wide-ranging in his coverage in so far as the German universities are concerned. Here and there, Frank discusses the fundamental impact made by the friars upon the intellectual life of a particular university. It is argued that it was the institution of Franciscan chairs in the faculty of theology of Erfurt University which was decisive in leading the theological school away from the philosophy of William of Ockham and towards that of Duns Scotus.

It has to be said that this is a general and impressionist study which is rather short on specifics. It is written in the form of a continuous narrative, there being no chapter divisions or sections of any kind. The work is largely of a derivative nature, and scholars who have an acquaintance with this topic will find little that is either novel or particularly illuminating.

UNIVERSITY OF LIVERPOOL

ALAN B. COBBAN

Gioacchino da Fiore. Aspetti inediti della vita e delle opere. By Pietro De Leo. (Biblioteca di Storia e Cultura Meridionale.) Pp. x + 198. Soveria Mannelli: Rubbettino Editore, 1988. L. 28,000

This book, a melange of two essays and four editions (all of works by Joachim of Fiore edited here for the first time), could be subtitled 'the Joachim nobody knows'. In so far as the book has a theme, it is the career and thought of Joachim the little-known abbot, rather than Joachim the well-known prophet. De Leo's first essay deals explicitly with Joachim's monastic activities, and two of the texts he edits, *De prescientia Dei* and *De Maria Magdalena et Maria sorore Lazari*, display Joachim in a quotidian abbatial teaching role. Two of the remaining items, an essay on 'The age of Constantine in Joachim's writings' (identical to an article published in 1988 by De Leo in the new journal of Joachim studies, *Florensia*), and the edition of a short '*professio fidei*', feel out of place. But the fourth text, Joachim's *Intelligentia super calathis*, fits the theme to some degree since it is dedicated to another abbot (perhaps Geoffrey of Auxerre) and at one point emphasises the monastic virtue of humility.

Since De Leo appears to be a reasonably trustworthy editor (the only major flaw I notice is his neglect of Rome, Carmelite Archive, ms III varia i, for establishing the text of *De prescientia Dei*), specialists will be glad to have four more hitherto unedited works of the abbot in print. De Leo also offers some useful

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observations: the Jeremiah Commentary parts company from Joachim's genuine works concerning the role of Constantine in the history of salvation; the abbot's choice of the dialogue form for a treatise on predestination shows how well he knew appropriate genres; the 'Benedict' in the dialogue on predestination could have been the Florentian abbot who fled to the Franciscan convent of Pisa in 1247; the short tract on the 'Marys' shows Joachim's willingness to read Scripture literally when appropriate.

The most interesting question raised by this collection is posed by Jean Leclercq in a provocative introduction: is there a 'Joachim moine' different from 'Joachim prophète'? Leclercq implicitly tends to the affirmative, stating that, 'ce qui frappe en ce "Joachim moine", c'est le bon sens... en particulier l'insistance sur l'obéissance, l'humilité, la foi simple'. Yet what strikes me is that Joachim never addressed himself to writing about monasticism solely for itself, and that even in the ostensibly quotidian didactic works presented here he very often reveals a preoccupation with change over time. Perhaps the clearest example occurs when he has the monk Benedict break into a dithyramb about how human ignorance will be dissipated in 'the splendour of the future', even while this young student should be bowing his head during instruction on predestination. C'est magnifique, mais ce n'est pas le bon sens.

NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY,
EVANSTON, ILLINOIS

ROBERT E. LERNER

Nostalgie di unità. Saggi di storia dell'ecumenismo. By Giuseppe Alberigo. (Dabar'. Saggi di storia religiosa, 8.) Pp. 175. Genoa: Marietti, 1989. L. 22,000. 88 211 6800 X

A grand master in the complex field of fifteenth-century conciliar history here brings together ten essays especially concerned with the relation between church history and ecumenical dialogue. The issue is given sharpness by the fact that modern ecclesiastical historiography is not partisan pleading on behalf of a particular confessional stance, so that, while partisans are not yet dead, their work is not much attended to by the learned. A special interest of Alberigo lies in the conversations and bitter disappointments between Greek East and Latin West, where the papal claim to universal jurisdiction and in effect absolute monarchy over the entire Church is a stone of stumbling over more than nine centuries. An important essay discusses the Libri Carolini and the critique of Greek veneration for icons. There is a profound analysis of the Council of Lyon and the thirteenth-century negotiations, including those with the kingdom of Nicaea. Henry VIII, Luther and Angelo Maria Querini, eighteenth-century archbishop of Corfu, are looked at with a delicate mixture of sympathy and academic detachment. The closing chapters deal with more recent endeavours. Underlying the essays lies a hesitant answer to the questions whether an Ultramontane Catholicism can converse with ecumenical partners without a hidden agenda of surrender and submission, and whether an Orthodoxy or Catholicism minus the pope, on the Anglican model, can retain coherence and survive the cold winds of atheistic secularism.

Alberigo's essays are supplied with excellent footnotes and references, and his book deserves very respectful attention. Nostalgia is not despair.

PETERHOUSE,
CAMBRIDGE

HENRY CHADWICK